

# Understanding the communicative environment - II

NPTTEL

*MOOC*  
*Soft skills*  
*development*

**Priyadarshi Patnaik**  
Professor  
Department of Humanities & Social Sciences  
Indian Institute of Technology Kharagpur

# Overview

- Take a survey
- Different types of communication?
  - Verbal
  - Nonverbal
  - Music
  - Visual
- Culture and context
  - Context and its meaning
  - Culture and its impact
- The new media and communication
  - How technology has transformed communication
  - The needs to learn new things about communication

# Take a survey

- **Communication Survey** (University of Louisville)  
*[https://louisville.edu/ombuds/surveys/COMMUNICATION%20SURVEY%20QUESTIONS.pdf/at\\_download/file](https://louisville.edu/ombuds/surveys/COMMUNICATION%20SURVEY%20QUESTIONS.pdf/at_download/file)*
- **How Good are your Communication Skills**  
(Mindtools)  
*[https://www.mindtools.com/pages/article/newCS\\_99.htm](https://www.mindtools.com/pages/article/newCS_99.htm)*

Please enter your self-assessment scores in the Discussion Forum Link provided so that we can know what is the general level of communication skills of this class.

# Verbal

- **Speaking**
  - **Listening**
  - Reading
  - Writing
- 
- In this course we will primarily focus on the first two

# Nonverbal

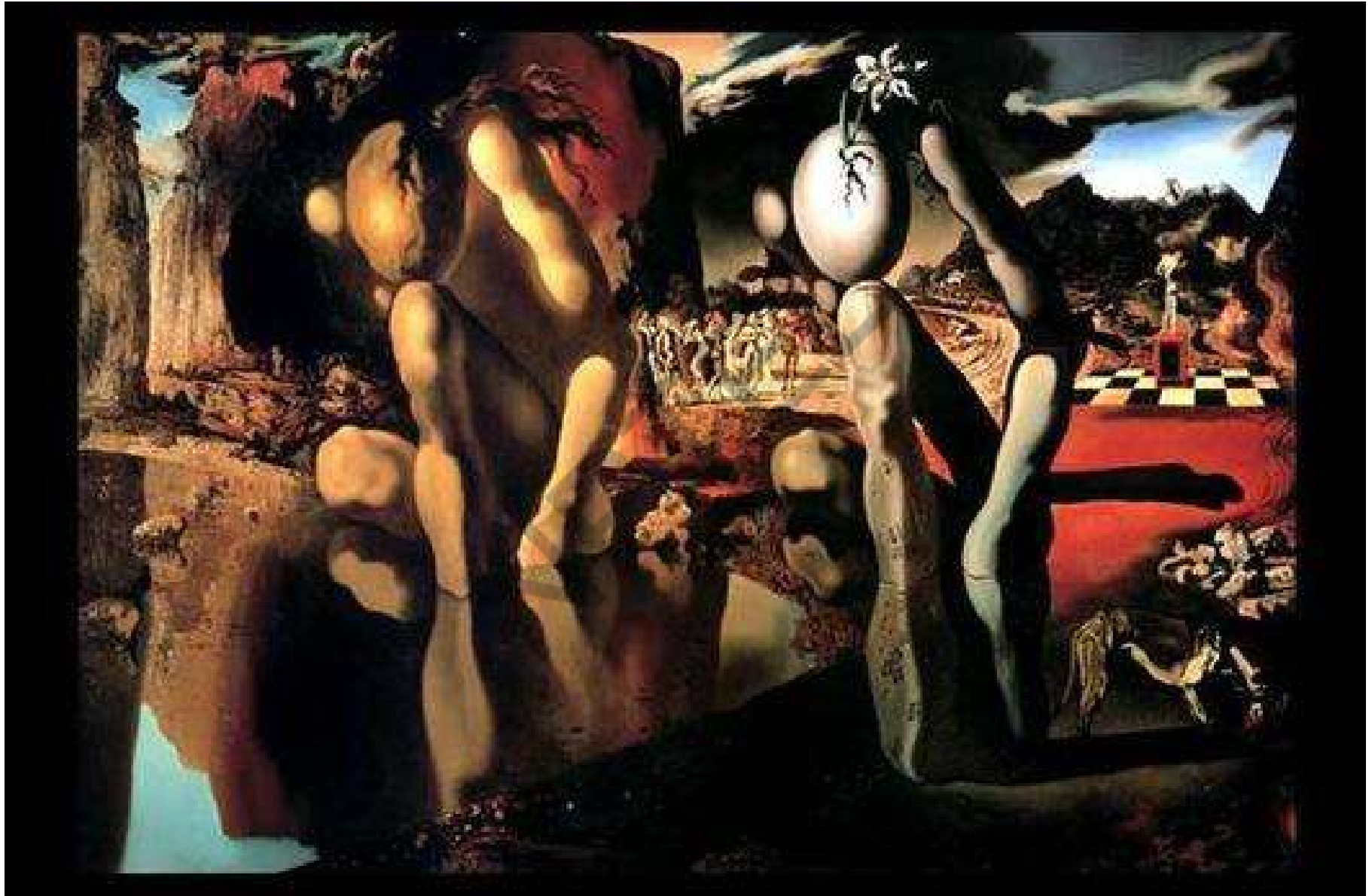
- Facial expressions
- Postures and Gestures
- Lies and truth
- Culture and context
- emotions
- Relevance for communication and soft skills

# Sound and music

- Noise and sounds
- Music
- Musical meaning
- Music and emotions
- Applying them in the communicative context

# Visual

- The rise of the visual
- Visuals as supplement
- Visuals and multimedia
- Communicating effectively using visual and multimedia support



*Salvador Dali, The metamorphosis of Narcissus, 1937 (Wikipedia)*

# Culture

- Culture
- Subculture
- Culture to context...

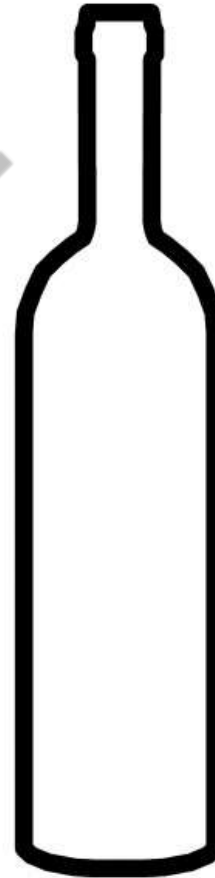
# Context

- The gods must be crazy

- Medieval Europe

- Glass making

- Water



# New media and communication

- What is new media?
  - online newspapers
  - blogs
  - Wikis
  - video games
  - social media
- The key characteristic – dialogue, interaction
- Features that recur:
  - being manipulated
  - networkable
  - dense
  - compressible
  - interactive

# Learning new concepts

- Social media
- Social network
- Multimedia
- E-learning and pedagogy
- Hypermedia
- ...

# Summary of key points

- Communication is complex but an essential soft skill
- It involves sender, receiver and channels; also context, and culture; filters and barriers
- It uses many channels – verbal, nonverbal, auditory and visual
- New technologies have influenced communication and we need to be aware of them

# References

- Metamorphosis of Narcissus. Wikipedia.  
[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Metamorphosis\\_of\\_Narcissus](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Metamorphosis_of_Narcissus)
- Manovich, Lev. (2003) "New Media From Borges to HTML." *The New Media Reader*. Ed. Noah Wardrip-Fruin & Nick Montfort. Cambridge, Massachusetts. PP.13-25